

SFL Thunder 9U — Fall Season Kickoff

Talking-head video script · short cut · ~3 minutes

1. Open

Hey Thunder families — Joe here. Quick video before we start the fall season. Five things: registration, balances, budget notes, a coaching update, and expectations. Let's go.

2. Registration — Payment 1

Payment 1 is \$500. That covers fall registration. Both registration and payment go through the link below. Please knock it out ASAP so we can lock in rosters.

https://login.stacksports.com/login?client_id=612b0399b1854a002e427f78&redirect;_uri=https://core-api.bluesombrero.com/login/redirect/portal/81034&app;_name=South+Florida+Thunder&portalid;=81034&instancekey;=leagues

3. Outstanding Balances

Because of our fundraising, **the season is covered for anyone without add-ons and without a prior balance rolling over.** Thank you to every family that made that happen.

If you **do** have a balance, you'll get an **invoice on the 1st of each month.** Need to split it into payments across the season? Just text me and we'll work it out. Nobody gets left behind over money.

4. Budget Disclosures

Two honest notes:

- **Thunder org fees went from \$150 to \$300 per player.** Set at the org level, not by us — but it hits our budget.
- **We're paying for two umpires per game now instead of one.** That expense doubled.

Everything else is managed tight. Want to see the numbers? My door is open.

5. Welcoming Dan

Dan is joining our coaching staff. His skill set will benefit every kid on this team and all of us as coaches. Excited to have him.

6. Three Things About This Season

One — kid pitch. The game will be slower and messier, especially early. There will be walks. There will be rough innings. That's normal. Bring patience.

Two — players will sit more. Strict pitch counts, tracked at a high level. Rule of thumb: a player must throw **at least 50% strikes in practice** to earn the mound in a game. Pitching is earned — practice, mechanics, control, and mental toughness.

Three — effort is the standard. We don't expect perfection. We expect effort. Hustle on and off the field, run everything out. **No throwing helmets, no shutting down after a strikeout, no blaming umpers or teammates.** Errors are baseball. Attitude is a choice.

7. Parents in the Stands

- Cheer for **our** team — not against theirs. Positive only.
- **No yelling instructions** during at-bats or on defense. One voice coaches: the coach.
- **No arguing balls and strikes.** We'll handle legit issues.
- No comments about other kids, teams, or families where kids can hear it.

Our kids need to see adults model the sportsmanship we're asking of them.

8. Talking with Coaches

Happy to talk about **your player** anytime — development, what he needs to improve, how you can help at home, his strengths.

What we won't do: emotional playing-time discussions, or conversations about other kids' playing time, position, or ability. Give it time, then come talk. We'll keep it productive.

9. Attendance

Update availability early. Lineups, pitching plans, and rotations depend on it. Baseball is a team commitment — please treat games and tournaments that way whenever you reasonably can.

10. Close

Success this fall isn't just wins and losses. It's watching these kids handle the transition, hustle, and pick each other up.

We're going to coach them hard, support them harder, and give them every chance to become better players and better teammates.

Thanks for trusting us with your kid. **Go Thunder.**

Companion message to send with the video:

Thunder families — quick 3-min video with the fall essentials: Payment 1 (\$500), how balances get invoiced, budget notes, welcoming Dan, and season expectations. Long version available on request.

Registration & Payment 1:

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Questions or need a payment plan? Text me directly. — Joe